

SIMON OKELLO

Engineering Leader | Fintech & Payments | Platform & DevOps
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SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 4+ years building and scaling payment platforms at SasaPay, currently CTO leading a team of 10 engineers across backend, DevOps and QA. Hands-on background in Python, API design and cloud infrastructure, with a track record of turning platform work into measurable business results: payment APIs that added Shs 300M in annual revenue, a Wallet-as-a-Service product that grew API revenue 40%, and partner onboarding made 50% faster. Looking for an Engineering Manager or Tech Lead role where I can grow high-performing teams while staying close to the architecture.

CORE STRENGTHS

Leadership: Team building and hiring, mentoring and 1:1s, roadmap planning, stakeholder management, Agile/Scrum delivery
Architecture: Payment systems, mobile money, API platforms (REST, GraphQL, gRPC), system reliability
Engineering: Python (Django, FastAPI), JavaScript (React, Node.js), PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis/Celery
Platform & DevOps: AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Ansible, GitOps (ArgoCD), Jenkins, GitHub Actions

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer

May 2025 – Present

Viewtech Limited (SasaPay), Nairobi

- Lead engineering strategy and a team of 10 engineers across software development, DevOps and QA, aligning the technical roadmap with company revenue goals.
- Own architecture for SasaPay's core products (Wallet-as-a-Service, payment APIs, developer platform), processing over 100 million transactions worth more than Shs 5 billion.
- Introduced team-wide engineering and delivery processes, improving on-time delivery by 70%.
- Hired 8 engineers and promoted 2 team members into senior roles.
- Standardised CI/CD and cloud infrastructure across all product lines, cutting release time by 80%.

Senior Software & DevOps Engineer (Tech Lead)

Dec 2021 – Apr 2025

Viewtech Limited (SasaPay), Nairobi

- Designed and led delivery of the Wallet-as-a-Service (WAAS) API; adoption grew 60% and API-driven revenue grew 40%.
- Built and optimised C2B, B2C and B2B payment APIs, increasing transaction volume 30% and adding about Shs 300M in annual revenue.
- Led integrations with partner banks, telcos and merchants, growing the partner ecosystem 25%.
- Raised test coverage and code quality standards across the team, reducing downtime 30% and saving about Shs 15M a year.
- Rebuilt the SasaPay Developer Portal and API documentation, cutting partner onboarding time by 50%.
- Ran technical onboarding for enterprise clients, reducing integration time 20% and improving retention 15%.

Earlier Experience

Jun 2018 – Oct 2021

Sama Kenya & CloudFactory Kenya

- Quality Analyst, Sama (2021): reviewed AI training data to 98% accuracy and coached annotation agents on quality and throughput.
- Data Entry Specialist, CloudFactory (2018–2021): data verification and reporting for international clients; built the attention to detail and process discipline I bring to engineering teams.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Quickmart Asset Management System (Python, Django REST, React, Celery). Built a multi-branch asset tracking system for Quickmart Supermarket, improving tracking efficiency 50% and reducing losses by about Shs 30M a year.

NexusPay Sacco (Python, Django REST, Celery). Digital payments platform for Nexus Payments Sacco.

HashLix (Python). Service that resolves hashed identifiers to mobile numbers and validates carrier networks.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

BSc Business Technology, Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology, 2018

DevOps Certificate, Moringa School, 2023